



Alienware 17 launched

Alienware launched the 17 inch and 14 inch gaming laptop featuring a Core i7 processor and NVIDIA 700 series GPU. <http://dgit.in/14K4P06>

Laptops stolen

State sponsored laptops meant for school students stolen in Sholavaram, Tamil Nadu. <http://dgit.in/187IquU>

traditional hinge design which lets the screen go as far back as resting flat on what is otherwise the underside of the machine, when in laptop mode. While the flexibility is appreciated and critical when you use the touchscreen, there is a bit of a design issue when you use the so-called tablet mode – the keyboard is exposed. This means, you are holding the Yoga 13 and may inadvertently press the keys and you need to be very careful when you place this flat on any surface in this mode.

Apart from this niggle, the Yoga 13 is rather well built. The 16.9mm thickness remains consistent throughout, and the flat slab design looks rather neat because of the dual colour (orange and black) matte finish. The texture and finish on the keyboard deck can pick up a bit of dust at times, though.

The performance of the Core i5-3317U chip is pretty much at par with other machines with the same processor, but the real highlight of the Yoga 13 is witnessed by its comes with the 329 minutes of tested battery life. This is by far the best among all machines in this test, and will easily translate into 8+ hours of backup easily in a typical day at work routine.

The Samsung PM830 SSD is fully SATA III capable (the Dell XPS 12) has the same storage version, but inexplicably, Lenovo has limited this drive's performance with SATA II. The 265 MB/s sequential read speed pales in comparison to the 452.7 MB/s the same drive gets on the XPS 12.

Dell XPS 12 Convertible

The Dell XPS 12 Convertible's chassis is made from machined aluminum, while the thin but strong display frame, including

the flip hinge, sports anodized aluminum. A very premium look and feel to the machine, but if we were to nit-pick, we would say that the only thing missing is the heat-channeling layer of silicon on the base that was designed into the XPS 14 ultrabook. The unique design element of Dell XPS 12 is the rotating display – connected on two sides, you need to push back softly at either the top, or push towards you from behind the display at the bottom, and the display will rotate a full 180 degrees. Now, this is useful if you want to show something to someone sitting across the table, or to fold over the keyboard and collapse into sort-of tablet mode. Unfortunately, there seems to be no lock when the display is set on the conventional ultrabook mode, and that can be an inconvenience if the laptop is subjected to sudden jerks or handled slightly roughly.

The benchmark tests peg the performance at the same level



Sony Vaio Pro 13

as the other machines running the Core i5-3317U processor, but that wouldn't show till you clean the machine by uninstalling all unnecessary preloaded apps and trials. The onboard SSD is fairly quick, with only the Toshiba SSD on the Vaio Pro 13 leading the scoring charts. What impresses the most is the 300

minutes the battery clocked in our benchmark tests.

Winners

For this test, we have divided all machines across three price bands, to make the results more relevant for you and the budget you have kept at a side for the laptop purchase.

Best Performer: Lenovo IdeaPad Yoga 13

This was one of the first touchscreen Windows 8 laptops to hit the markets, and the results show that it is still the best performer among the bunch. That advantage is mostly because of the excellent battery life on offer, something most rivals are unable to even come close to. Buy this if you want something that can be a laptop, a tablet or even some more weird shapes, as and when you please!

Best Value (Category 1): HP ENVY TouchSmart 11

The Asus VivoBook F202e was the premium small screen machine to buy, till the HP TouchSmart 11 came along. At a price considerably lower than the F202e, you get relatively similar performance, but much better battery life. Good to see that HP has completely recreated the excellent keyboard of the bigger ENVY notebooks in this form factor.

Best Value (Category 2): Asus VivoBook S550CA

At the time when we had first reviewed the S550CA, the standout factor was the fact that ASUS had packed in the touchscreen without adding bulk to the entire form factor – something where a lot of rivals had faltered. A fairly good keyboard, a powerful graphics chip and

very good battery life make this an all-rounder ultrabook, at an affordable price point.

Best Value (Category 3): Series 5 Ultra Touch (NP-540U3C)

Like the Yoga 13, this machine has been in the market for quite some time now. And yet,



ASUS VivoBook S550C

it remains one of the better options that can be considered. The build quality is very good, one of the brightest displays among the rivals and an excellent battery life. The only thing missing in this particular version is a powerful graphics card.

Editor's Pick: Sony Vaio Pro 13

One of the rare Haswell powered ultrabooks in India at the moment, the Vaio's super light and slim body, excellent build quality/looks, ever-lasting battery life, high-resolution IPS touch screen display and the zippy overall performance come together to make it a very good deal for its asking price of ₹74,990. There isn't a single ultrabook in the market today that offers the same level of quality and refinement at this price point. We would recommend this to anyone who wants the latest hardware and the best possible display in a sleek and sophisticated design.